

PREVENT EMAIL FROM REVEALING MORE THAN INTENDED

The visible From field is not the only information in an email. Headers can contain routing, authentication and technical details. In Gmail on the web, open a message, select More > Show original to inspect the full header. Outlook provides message details or internet headers through its viewing options.

Before sending from a pseudonymous account:

1. Confirm the selected From and Reply-To addresses.
2. Remove automatic signatures containing a full name, employer, phone number or office location.
3. Check quoted conversation history for earlier identifiers.
4. Rename attachments and inspect document properties.

5. Avoid sharing cloud links owned by a real-name account.
6. Send a test email to another inbox and inspect what the recipient sees.
7. Keep different identities in separate browser profiles or mail applications.

Email newsletters can include remote images that report when a message is opened and disclose an IP-derived location. Apple's Mail Privacy Protection hides the recipient's IP address from senders and prevents them from reliably learning whether a message was opened. Other clients may offer controls to block remote images. These features reduce tracking; they do not hide replies, link clicks or account identity.

4. Mark the result as verified.
5. Treat an unexpected safety-number change as a reason to pause and confirm, not immediate proof of an attack.
6. Never share registration codes, Signal PINs or backup recovery keys in a chat.

Signal warns that its staff will not ask for a PIN or recovery key through messages, calls or social media. An encrypted scam remains a scam.

Use disappearing messages for retention, not trust

Disappearing messages reduce how long conversation history remains on participants' devices. They suit temporary addresses, schedules and information that does not require permanent storage. They do not prevent screenshots, copied text, external photographs or malicious retention. Signal explicitly says the

feature is not intended for situations where the recipient is an adversary.

To configure them:

1. Open a conversation and tap the contact or group name.
2. Select Disappearing messages.
3. Choose a duration suited to the information.
4. Confirm that participants understand the expectation.
5. Send essential records through an approved archival route rather than relying on chat history.
6. Review linked devices, because delivered messages may appear on each one.
7. Delete unnecessary downloads and exported files separately.

"View once" media similarly reduces ordinary retention inside the conversation, but it should not be treated as protection against a determined recipient. The safest sensitive file is often one that was never sent.

Review backups and linked devices

Messages may be encrypted in transit yet remain exposed on a forgotten desktop, tablet or backup. In Signal, open Settings > Linked devices and remove anything you no longer control. Do the same after selling, repairing or losing a computer.

Signal offers optional Secure Backups protected by end-to-end encryption and a recovery key that Signal cannot recover if lost. Android also supports encrypted on-device backups. Choose deliberately rather than assuming "cloud" or "local" is automatically safer.

Keep recovery keys outside ordinary chat, screenshots and unencrypted notes. If no historical record is needed, disable

